

IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY

Master of Fine Arts in Graphic Design

The MFA in Graphic Design is recognized as the terminal degree in the field and requires a minimum of 60-credits. M.F.A. graduates in Graphic Design are skilled in communication design, problem solving, and are adept in the use of visual language, symbology, and interaction. Graduates are proficient in the design of communications and the use of technologies that incorporate human interaction with environments, objects, and electronic and traditional publications. Students and faculty work collaboratively on a required thesis; integrating theory, creation, research, and design problem solving.

Graphic Design Required Studios

33 Credits

ArtGr 5110	Fall	Graphic Design Graduate Studio I	3cr
ArtGr 5120	Fall	Audience & Perception	3cr
ArtGr 5210	Spring	Graphic Design Graduate Studio II	3cr
ArtGr 5220	Spring	Critical Media	3cr
ArtGr 5300	Fall	User Engagement	3cr
ArtGr 6100	Spring	Thesis Preparation Studio	3cr
ArtGr 5400	Spring	Graphic Design for Behavioral Change	3cr
ArtGr 6200	Fall	Graduate Thesis Studio I	3cr
ArtGr 6300	Spring	Graduate Thesis Studio II	3cr
DSN S 5460	Spring	Interdisciplinary Design Option Studio	6cr

Graphic Design Seminars

6 Credits

ArtGr 5100	Fall	Graphic Design Theory	3cr
DSN S 5010x	Fall	Introduction to Research Design:	3cr

Elective Focus Area

9 Credits

Outside of Graphic Design but supports area of research or creative practice.

Elective Studio	3cr
Elective Studio, Seminar, or Preparing Future Faculty (PFF)	3cr
Elective Studio, Seminar, or Preparing Future Faculty (PFF)	3cr

Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism

9 Credit

5000 or 6000-level art/design history, theory, criticism seminars in the College of Design.

Options vary by semester. Make selections with support from DoGE/major professor.

Thesis

3-6 Credits

ArtGr 6990	Fall / Spring	Thesis Credits with Major Professor	3-6cr
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Total

(not including any potential prerequisites or additional Graduate College requirements)

60 Credits Minimum

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Master of Fine Arts in Graphic Design

Suggested Three-Year Course Sequence

Year One

Fall

ArtGr 5100 Seminar
ArtGr 5110 Studio
ArtGr 5120 Studio
Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism

Graphic Design Theory
Graphic Design Graduate Studio I
Audience & Perception

12 Credits

3cr*
3cr*
3cr*
3cr

Spring

DSN S 5460 Studio
ArtGr 5210 Studio
ArtGr 5220 Studio

Interdisciplinary Design Option Studio
Graphic Design Graduate Studio II
Critical Media

12 Credits

6cr
3cr*
3cr*

Year Two

Fall

ArtGr 5300 (ArtGr 6720A) Studio
DsnS 5010x Seminar:
Elective Focus Area
Preparing Future Faculty (PFF)

User Engagement
Introduction to Research Design

9 Credits

3cr*
3cr*
3cr
1cr (Optional)

Spring

ArtGr 5400 (ArtGr 6720B) Studio
ArtGr 6100 Studio

Graphic Design for Behavioral Change
Thesis Preparation Studio

9 Credits

3cr*
3cr*

Preparing Future Faculty (PFF)

—or— Elective Focus Area

3cr

Year Three

Fall

ArtGr 6200 Studio
Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism:
Elective Focus Area

Graduate Thesis Studio I

9 Credits

3cr*
3cr
3cr

Spring

ArtGr 6300 Studio
ArtGr 6990
Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism

Graduate Thesis Studio II
Thesis Credits with Major Professor

9 Credits

3cr*
3cr
3cr

* = Required Sequence

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Master of Fine Arts in Graphic Design

Optional Two-Year Course Sequence

(Optional. Full Admits Only. Not possible with any additional Grad College course requirements)

Year One

Fall

ArtGr 5100 Seminar

ArtGr 5110 Studio

ArtGr 5120 Studio

DsnS 5010x Seminar

Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism:

Graphic Design Theory

Graphic Design Graduate Studio I

Audience & Perception

Introduction to Research Design

15 Credits

3cr*

3cr*

3cr*

3cr

3cr

Spring

DSN S 5460 Studio

ArtGr 5210 Studio

ArtGr 5220 Studio

ArtGr 6100 Studio

Interdisciplinary Design Option Studio

Graphic Design Graduate Studio II

Critical Media

Thesis Preparation Studio

15 Credits

6cr

3cr*

3cr*

3cr*

Year Two

Fall

ArtGr 5300 Studio

ArtGr 6200 Studio

Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism

Elective Focus Area:

Elective Focus Area

User Engagement

Graduate Thesis Studio I

15 Credits

3cr

3cr*

3cr

3cr

3cr

—or— Preparing Future Faculty (PFF)

1cr

Spring

ArtGr 5400 Studio

ArtGr 6300 Studio

ArtGr 6990

Elective Focus Area

—or— Preparing Future Faculty (PFF)

Art/Design History, Theory, Criticism

Graphic Design for Behavioral Change

Graduate Thesis Studio II

Thesis Credits with Major Professor

15 Credits

3cr

3cr*

3cr

3cr

3cr

3cr

* = Required Sequence